

Cash Got Your Tongue?

CEO Language-Uncertainty Around Undisclosed Cash Acquisitions

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THE EVENT CLOCK

PRIVATE COMMITMENT

EARNINGS CALL
Q&A

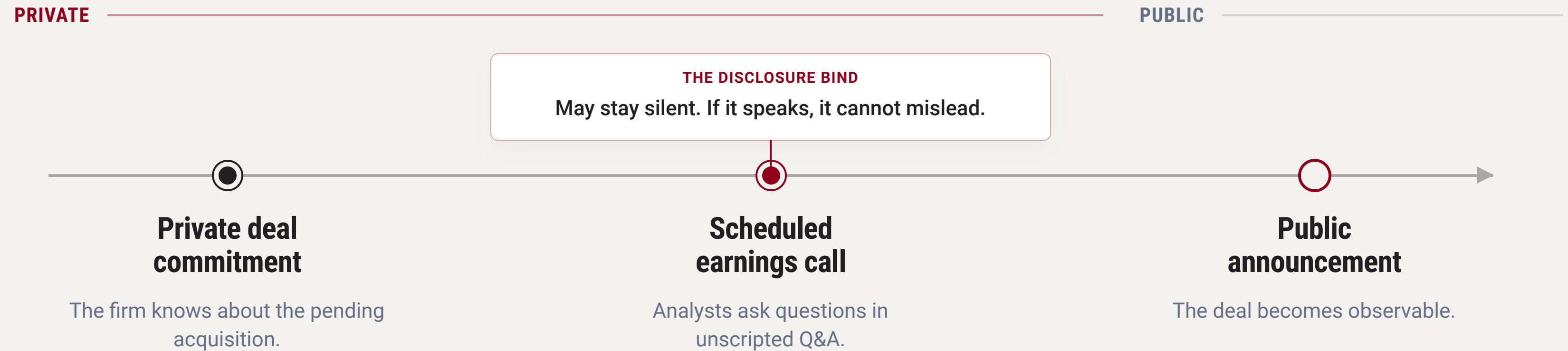
PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT

Can the spoken record reveal
what the firm withholds?



A firm knows, but cannot say

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— Does withholding leave a trace in the CEO's language?

Conceptual setting: thesis Chapter 2; *Basic v. Levinson* (1988); Rule 10b-5.